Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Privacy Configuration Guide

Privacy thresholds, exclusion lists, data residency & compliance controls

Document Property	Value
Section	Setup
Audience	IT Admin / Governance
Version	4.0
Published	April 2026

How This Document Fits

This is a **Setup** guide. It covers the privacy and compliance settings that govern how Copilot Analytics data is collected, stored, and displayed. Configure these settings *before* enabling dashboards or running queries.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup (you are here)	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

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1. Privacy Thresholds

Privacy thresholds ensure that no individual user's behaviour is identifiable in aggregated results. Any group below the configured minimum has its data suppressed entirely.

Setting	Default	Configurable Range
Minimum group size	10 users	5–unlimited (lowest allowed = 5)

How Thresholds Work

- **Data suppression:** Results for groups below the threshold are suppressed — they show as blank or "insufficient data" rather than displaying potentially identifiable information.
- **No individual visibility:** No individual user behaviour is ever visible in the Copilot Dashboard, Power BI reports, or query results.
- **Differential privacy:** Automatically applied to aggregated results. Small amounts of statistical noise are added so that any single person's data cannot be reverse-engineered from the output.
- **Distribution masking:** Hides results where "almost all" or "almost none" of the users fit a particular profile, preventing inference about individuals in near-unanimous groups.

> **Minimum Team Size vs Minimum Group Size — They Are Different**
>
> These two settings apply in different contexts and are configured in different places. Both have a minimum of 5.
>
> | Setting | Where Configured | What It Controls |
> |---|---|---|
> | **Minimum team size** | Viva Insights → Admin → **Manager settings** | Manager-facing insights (My Team tab, Copilo |
> | **Minimum group size** | Viva Insights → Admin → **Privacy settings** | Copilot Dashboard aggregated views, Power E |
>
> **Example:** If both are set to 5, a manager with exactly 4 direct reports will see their team data (4 reports + 1 manager = 5, meeting the team size threshold), but an analyst filtering a dashboard to a group of 4 users will see suppressed data (4 < 5, below the group size threshold).

2. Exclusion Lists

Exclusion lists remove specific users from all Copilot Analytics and Viva Insights reporting. Excluded users' activity data is not collected, processed, or displayed anywhere.

What Gets Excluded

- Copilot Dashboard — excluded users do not appear in any dashboard metric
- Viva Insights behavioural reports (collaboration hours, meeting patterns, etc.)
- M365 Copilot Chat (web) usage data
- Advanced Analytics query results (Power BI person queries, meeting queries, etc.)

How to Upload

Method	Steps
CSV upload	Prepare a CSV with user email addresses → Viva Insights web app → Admin → Privacy settings →
Entra ID groups	Create or select an Entra security group containing users to exclude → Viva Insights web app → A

Processing Times

Action	Time to Take Effect
Adding users to exclusion list	Up to **5 days**
Removing users from exclusion list	Up to **3 days**

> **Plan Exclusions Before Dashboard Launch**
>
> Because exclusions take up to 5 days to apply, configure your exclusion lists **before** enabling the Copilot Dashboard (VFAM). This avoids a window where excluded users' data briefly appears in reports.

3. Data Residency

Copilot Analytics data is processed and stored in the **same geographic region** as your Microsoft 365 tenant. No additional configuration is required for data residency — it follows your tenant's existing data location settings.

Verification Steps

1. Go to **M365 Admin Centre → Settings → Org settings → Organization profile → Data location**.
2. Confirm the listed region meets your compliance and regulatory requirements.
3. If your organisation has specific data sovereignty requirements, consult your compliance team to verify that the tenant region satisfies them.

3B. Microsoft Purview DLP for Copilot Prompts

Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP) now extends to **Microsoft 365 Copilot prompts**, providing an additional security layer for organisations deploying Copilot at scale. While Copilot Analytics focuses on adoption and impact measurement, DLP for Copilot addresses the security and governance side of the deployment.

What It Does

Admins can define DLP policies that detect and restrict prompts containing **sensitive information types (SITs)**. When a user submits a Copilot prompt that matches a DLP policy, Copilot will **not respond** to the prompt and will not use it for web grounding.

Coverage

Capability	Status	Scope
DLP for Copilot prompts	Generally Available	Microsoft 365 Copilot — blocks prompts containing
DLP for web search queries	Public Preview	Prevents prompts with SITs from being used in web
DSPM for AI: Oversharing remediation	Generally Available	Identify and bulk-remediate overshared SharePoint
Purview in M365 Admin Centre	Generally Available	IT admins can view oversharing risks and enable DL

Why This Matters for Analytics Teams

- **DLP-blocked prompts are not counted as Copilot actions** in the Dashboard or Viva Insights. If DLP policies block a significant number of prompts, this may appear as lower-than-expected Copilot usage in your analytics.
- **Oversharing remediation** reduces the risk that Copilot surfaces sensitive documents in responses, which is a prerequisite concern many organisations raise before expanding Copilot deployment.
- Consider coordinating with your **Security/Compliance team** to understand what DLP policies are in place and how they might affect adoption metrics.

Configuration Reference

DLP for Copilot is configured in the **Microsoft Purview Compliance Portal**, not in Viva Insights. Refer to your security team or the official documentation at aka.ms/Copilot/SecureGovern for deployment guidance.

> **Complementary to Analytics**
>
> DLP for Copilot and Copilot Analytics serve different purposes but are part of the same deployment posture. A well-governed Copilot deployment uses **DLP** to prevent sensitive data exposure, **Copilot Analytics** to measure adoption and impact, and **Organisational Messages** to drive enablement. Consider establishing a cross-functional team that includes Security (Purview), IT (Admin Centre), and Analytics (Viva Insights) stakeholders.

4. GDPR and Regional Compliance

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics is designed with GDPR compliance in mind. The following controls support regulatory requirements:

- **User opt-out:** Individual users can opt out of Viva Insights personal experiences via their settings. Exclusion lists (Section 2) provide admin-level opt-out for organisational compliance.
- **Data minimisation:** Only aggregated, de-identified data is surfaced in dashboards and reports. Differential privacy and distribution masking (Section 1) further protect individual data.
- **Org data handling:** If you upload organisational data (CSV with attributes like Department, Agency, Location), ensure the upload process follows your organisation's data handling policies. Do not include sensitive personal data in org data attributes.
- **Data subject requests:** Standard Microsoft 365 Data Subject Request (DSR) tools apply to Viva Insights data. Use the M365 Admin Centre to process access, export, or deletion requests.

> **Regional Considerations**
>
> Some regions may have additional requirements beyond GDPR (e.g., UK-GDPR, Australia Privacy Act). Work with your legal and compliance teams to confirm that your privacy threshold settings, exclusion lists, and org data handling meet local regulations.

5. Data Retention

Different analytics surfaces retain data for different periods. Plan your reporting cadence accordingly — if you need long-term trends, use Advanced Analytics with Power BI snapshots.

Data Source	Retention Period	Notes
Admin Centre Reports	Up to **180 days**	M365 Admin Centre → Reports → Usage
Copilot Dashboard	**28-day** rolling window	Always shows the most recent 28 days; no h
Advanced Analytics — Collaboration metrics	Up to **27 months**	Starts at 13 months; grows weekly as data a
Advanced Analytics — Copilot metrics	Up to **13 months**	Copilot-specific metrics (Assisted Hours, ac

> **Monthly Snapshots for Long-Term Trends**
>
> The Copilot Dashboard's 28-day rolling window means historical data is not preserved. To track trends over time, schedule monthly Power BI report refreshes and save snapshots. See the Analyst Playbook for snapshot scheduling guidance.

6. What to Read Next

Document	When to Use
Admin Setup Guide	Configure all five analytics tiers — roles, licences, VFAM, org data, and partitions
Troubleshooting Guide	Fix common issues: missing data, dashboard not appearing, suppressed metrics
Data Onboarding Guide	Upload and validate organisational data (CSV attributes, Entra sync)
Dashboard Guide	Understand each dashboard page and how to interpret the metrics

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